



Compliant on the Survey, Unlabelled in the Log

Matching Self-Reported Charter Adherence at the Community Pantry Against a Term of Volunteer Moderators' Removal Log

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The problem

The charter says take what you need, leave what you can. Moderators keep no removal form beyond a shared notebook. Do stated reasons match what actually gets logged?

Research questions

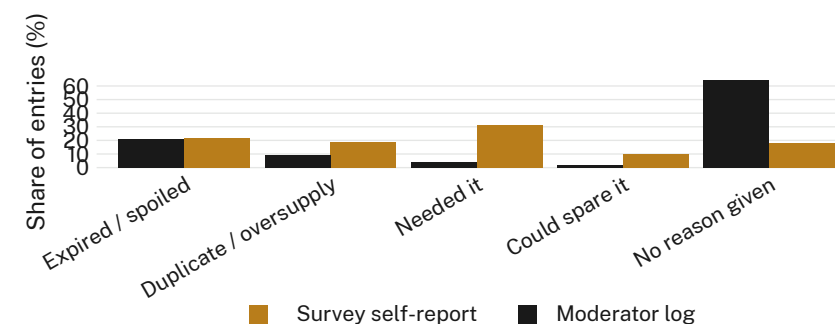
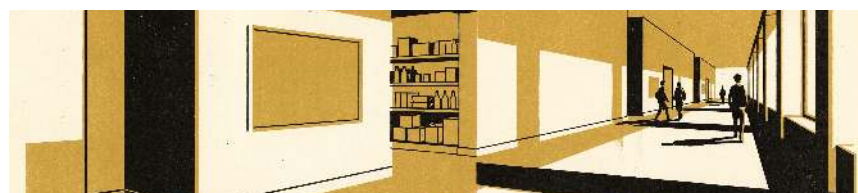
- Compare self-reported charter reasons against the removal log
- Test whether “need”/“spare” language survives into log entries
- Characterise what gets logged instead

Study design

- n = 214 · anonymous intercept survey · one term
- 361 log entries · coded to five charter reasons · 14 weeks
- two coders · categories held fixed

Findings

Self-report cites the charter's own reasons often; the log rarely does. A need-or spare-based reason appears in 6% of coded entries, against 41% of matched self-reports.



361 removals, 27 Apr–3 Aug 2026: 6% cite a charter reason; 64% cite none.

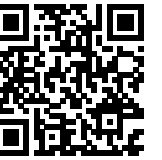
Implications & where next

Entries record what changed, rarely why; charter language survives in self-report, not the log. Next: a one-line reason tag at removal.

Selected references

1. Ostrom, E. (1990). *Governing the Commons: The Evolution of Institutions for Collective Action*. Cambridge University Press. doi:10.1017/CB09780511807763
 2. Morrow, O. (2019). Sharing food and risk in Berlin's urban food commons. *Geoforum*, 99, 202–212. doi:10.1016/j.geoforum.2018.09.003
 3. Berns, K., Rossitto, C., & Tholander, J. (2023). Learning from other communities: Organising collective action in a grassroots food-sharing initiative. *Computer Supported Cooperative Work*, 32(4), 951–999. doi:10.1007/s10606-023-09468-5
 4. Jo, J., Xie, J., Aiyer, P., Kneare, T., & Carroll, J. M. (2024). Infrastructing community fridges for food communing. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.*, 8(CSCW1), 1–27. doi:10.1145/3637352
 5. Crowne, D. P., & Marlowe, D. (1960). A new scale of social desirability independent of psychopathology. *Journal of Consulting Psychology*, 24(4), 349–354. doi:10.1037/h0047358
 6. Vandermeer, O., Tolan, A., & Umbile, P. (2026). *Freshly Worded, Still Adrift: A Taxonomy of Terms-of-Reference Drift After a University-Wide Charter Refresh*. School of Continuous Improvement. doi:10.5555/slop.glpjfv
- Anonymous intercept survey; log entries de-identified before coding; no membership data retained.

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“A shared shelf outlives its own rulebook.”

64% of a term's logged removals cite no charter reason at all.